JIMNY TALES 'N' TRAILS

# TRAILBLAZER




*A Maruti Suzuki Jimny from Chandigarh to Shimla? Now that's an adventure waiting to unfold. So, buckle up as we embark on a journey through the winding mountain roads in the nimble Jimny*

By **DIPAYAN DUTTA**

Our Maruti Suzuki Jimny, our companion its rugged silhouette hinted cheekily at the adventure that lay ahead. The sun was beginning its ascent, casting a golden hue over the city and started to light up the neon of our Jimny as the team and I prepared for an unconventional road trip. Our destination? The enchanting town of Shimla. Our chosen path? Only the trails that through the Himalayan foothills. The 90 km between Chandigarh and Shimla usually takes about 2 hours. Our route was 10 km shorter at 81, but it would take at least 10 hours. I had intended to do a recce before the drive to ensure none of the routes had been washed out by the savage effects of this year's monsoon, but Yogen had shot down the idea. "Make a way" he suggested in his usual calm dismissive tone, "you're driving the Jimny, you never turn back." So with those words of encouragement, and uncharacteristic faith in my skills, we set off for what would be one of the most challenging drives of my life.

As we ascended higher into the mountains, the air became cooler, and the scenery became even more breathtaking. Dense forests of pine and cedar trees surrounded us, and the occasional glimpse of snow-capped peaks in the distance added to the magic of the journey. Jimny's large windows provided a panoramic view, allowing us to fully appreciate







the natural beauty unfolding around us.As we approached Shimla, the trails transitioned into a blend of mud and stone the smell of pine now permeating into the cabin. We navigated through tight spots, the nimbleness of the vehicle allowing us to explore even the most challenging terrains. The off-road prowess of the Jimny was not just a feature; it was the essence of the journey.